

1.4 billion smartphone users

As per the current trend, worldwide smartphone usage is estimated to reach 1.4 billion this year
<http://dgit.in/WGrVCH>

**Intel Web TV box**

Intel media's corporate VP, Erik Huggers, has announced that Intel is slated to release its own media streamer by this year's end

The web this month

Updates that could change the way you browse the internet

It's been a month of interesting changes on the World Wide Web, with quite a few implication on the ways we use the internet – from the possibility of increased broadband rates to Facebook allowing users to address their concerns about privacy, directly. There were also some interesting statistics from various reports; read on to know more...

Facebook announces 'Ask Our CPO' series to address privacy concerns

Following users' privacy concerns around Graph Search, Facebook has come up with an explanatory blog post and video to assure users of the safety of the new feature. To assuage fears Facebook also announced the new "Ask Our CPO," initia-



Graph Search is Facebook's foray into the search domain

tive, which seeks questions or comments from users about Facebook's privacy policy.

"Before Graph Search began rolling out, we highlighted a set of upgraded privacy tools on Facebook encouraging people to review what they've shared. The upgraded privacy tools, and the reminder to use them, are part of an ongoing effort to encourage

people to make choices that are right for them," says Facebook's Michael Richter in a post.

"Privacy works consistently across Facebook, not just on Graph Search. When you control who you share your information with, you determine who it's shared with across Facebook – including News Feed, timeline and in Graph Search", said the post.

"In the "Ask Our CPO" series, we ask people to submit questions they have about privacy. In this first edition, Erin Egan, our Chief Privacy Officer of Policy, explains why we created this series and answers some questions she receives frequently about privacy," says the company.

"At Facebook, we work hard to build and maintain your trust. We understand that you'll want to share on Facebook only if you trust us to protect the privacy and security of your information. We also understand that issues about privacy can be complex given the fast-moving nature of technology and that you have questions about privacy."

Google+ becomes 2nd largest social platform

Google+ has moved to the second spot for social platforms while YouTube ranks third, ahead of Twitter, according to Trendstream's Global Web Index for Q4 2012.

According to the report, Facebook's active user count was around 693 million by 2012-end whereas Google+ had

some 343 million users. Facebook clearly leads the race with a huge margin while Google+ has quite a bit of catching up to do in the near future. However, Google's social networking site



Google Plus will soon have to be taken seriously in the social networking domain

has become popular enough to move past Twitter and YouTube.

"Data collected in GWI.8 (Q4 2012) demonstrates the continued shift in usage from localised social platforms to global ones with huge growth for Twitter, Google+ and Facebook. The fastest growing network in 2013 in terms of 'Active Usage' (defined as 'Used or contributed to in the past month') was Twitter which grew 40 percent to 288 million across our 31 markets (approximately 90 percent of global internet population). About 21 percent of the global internet population now uses Twitter actively on a monthly basis. This compares to 21 percent actively using YouTube, 25 percent actively using Google+ and a staggering 51 percent using Facebook on a monthly basis," says the report.

"Interestingly for Google, YouTube (not previously tracked by us as a social platform) comes in at number 3, demonstrating the immense

opportunity of linking Google's services through the G+ social layer. This is also a key indication of why Google+ integrated with the Google product set is so key to the future of search and the internet. We've got more coming on Google+ later this week as well," notes the report. The site saw growth in terms of active users by 27 percent to become the second largest social platform.

Forbes, in its report, points out that there's a "significant overlap between Google+ and YouTube in terms of users". "If all active YouTube users become active Google+ users (something not so difficult for Google to engineer) it would likely add a significant amount to those 343 million," points out the Forbes report.

Google+ has seen quite a few updates in recent times. Google renamed its Circles icon on the Google+ social networking service to "Find People". With the change, Google expects to increase engagement with new users, who normally don't know what Circles stands for and stay away from the section while figuring out the interface of the site. Other previous updates include the addition of a pan and zoom feature for high resolution images, a communities feature and new tools for business users.

Yahoo enters into a deal with Google for contextual online ads

Yahoo has entered into a global advertising deal with search giant Google, which will result